

The Prompt Framework

A good brief has three parts: a **Role**, a **Task** and a **Constraint**. My book calls it RTC. Fill in all three before you press enter, and the AI has far less to guess.



Role

Who should answer?

One line that tells the AI which expertise to draw on and what voice to use.

"Act as a finance manager who explains numbers to people outside finance."

Keep it to one line. A long role can't rescue a vague task.



Task

What do you need back?

Name the one thing you want, what it's about and who it's for. Most weak prompts fail here.

"Explain why our software costs went up last quarter, for the operations team."

One deliverable per message. If you need three things, send three messages.



Constraint

What limits should it fit?

Length, format, tone, audience and anything to leave out. Constraints decide the shape of what comes back.

"One paragraph, under 120 words, plain language, no acronyms."

If something in the answer would annoy you (jargon, a wall of text, a sales tone), rule it out up front.

COPY THIS

Act as [a role with the expertise this job needs]. **ROLE** [The one thing you need, what it's about, and who it's for.] **TASK** [Your limits: length, format, tone, audience, what to leave out.] **CONSTRAINT**

BEFORE

"Explain our software costs."

AFTER

Act as a finance manager who explains numbers to people outside finance. **ROLE** Explain why our software costs went up last quarter, for the operations team. **TASK** One paragraph, under 120 words, plain language, no acronyms, and end with the one line item they should watch. **CONSTRAINT**

WHY IT WORKS

The role sets the voice, the task names the question and the audience, and the constraints set the length and the ending. Every blank the AI used to fill with a guess now carries your answer.

The usual mistake

A detailed role and a thin task. The answer comes back polished and empty. When that happens, rewrite the task before you touch anything else.

After the first answer

Treat it as a first take and give one note at a time:

- "Cut it to five bullet points a manager can read in 30 seconds."
- "Too formal. Rewrite it the way you'd say it across a desk."
- "Add one example from [our industry] under the second point."

Which part to fix

- *Generic or off target:* add the details only you know to the task and constraints.
- *One part weak, the rest fine:* you asked for too much at once. Split it into separate messages.
- *Close, but not right:* keep the draft and give one precise note.

RTC in practice

Three everyday requests, before and after. The highlights show which part of the brief each phrase is doing.

A status update your boss will read

BEFORE

"Write a project update."

Act as a project manager writing for a busy director. **ROLE** Write this week's update on the [PROJECT] launch from my notes: [PASTE NOTES]. **TASK** Three short sections: done, next, and one risk that needs a decision. Under 150 words, with the decision in the first line. **CONSTRAINT**

What changed: the reader, the source material, and the one thing the reader has to act on. Without them the AI writes a generic status report for nobody in particular.

Making sense of a spreadsheet

BEFORE

"Analyze this data."

Act as a sales operations analyst. **ROLE** Here is last quarter's pipeline export: [PASTE]. Find the three biggest changes from the quarter before and give a likely reason for each. **TASK** A short table, then two sentences on what to check first. If the data can't support a reason, say so. **CONSTRAINT**

What changed: a question to answer and a format to answer in. The last line gives the AI permission to say the data can't tell, which makes a confident guess less likely.

Rewriting for customers

BEFORE

"Rewrite this for customers."

Act as a support lead who writes for customers with no technical background. **ROLE** Turn this release note into a short email to customers: [PASTE]. **TASK** Lead with what changes for them, then how to use it. Under 120 words, no internal product names, and one placeholder for the help-article link. **CONSTRAINT**

What changed: the audience, the order of information and the words to avoid, so the same note reads as if it was written for the people who'll get it.

THIS WEEK

Pick three requests you make every week. Write each one as an RTC brief, run it once, and fix whichever part missed. Save the version that works where you'll find it next week. Those three briefs are the start of a prompt library built from your own work.

WHERE RTC FITS

The Artificial Advantage

RTC is the L in CLEAR, the five-stage method my book is built on:

Choose your tools, **Lead** with clear direction, **Evolve** your outputs, **Audit** for accuracy, and **Repeat** to build a practice. The book walks you through all five, with worked examples and exercises you run on your own work.

See the book at elvinpeters.com/book.html



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